encounter Indian interests and India's traditional sphere of influence in several more aspects of its foreign policy than ever before. However, this policy is driven more by growing ambitions in China's strategy and foreign policy outlook than by Chinese calculations about India. Transforming itself from a land power to a land-sea hybrid power, China's geopolitical theatre has expanded, and its interests now encompass a larger region than earlier, on land as well as at sea.

If China through the Belt and Road Initiative manages to contribute with public goods and stability in Eurasia, including in India's neighbourhood, this would be no small achievement. It is difficult to argue that China is pursuing a more confrontative policy towards India now than in earlier periods, but the combination of an unresolved border dispute, growing power gap, and the ongoing shift in China's geopolitical reach gives it an unprecedented footprint in India's neighbourhood. As a consequence, India is certainly back on the geopolitical map in Beijing. Avoiding India turning into an obstacle in China's ambitious Eurasia policy, and preventing it from entering into an alliance with the United States, China is currently pursuing a mixed policy of "carrot and stick" towards India, and various balancing strategies are part of China's toolkit in its India policy.

Notes

1 Posen, Barry R. (1984) *The Sources of Military Doctrine: France, Britain, and Germany between the World Wars*, Cornell University Press, Ithaca, NY, p. 13.

2 Paul, T.V. (2004) "Introduction: The Enduring Axioms of Balance of Power Theory and Their Contemporary Relevance", in T.V. Paul, James J. Wirtz and Michel Fort-mann, eds., *Balance of Power: Theory and Practice in the 21st Century*, Stanford University Press, Stanford, CA.

3 Mearsheimer, John J. (2001) *The Tragedy of Great Power Politics*, W. W. Norton & Company, New York, p. 57.